



Lichen growing on trees is usually grey, green, or yellow.



First flowers

Ancient fossils show that some of the first flowers looked very much like magnolias. They share features that not all plants have, such as having many anthers.

Is it a plant?

Lichen, seen here growing on rotten trees, is a partnership of algae and fungi. Unlike algae, lichen and fungi are not plants because they do not make their own food through photosynthesis.

First plants

Non-flowering plants, such as ferns and mosses, are among the oldest plants in the world. About 300 million years ago great forests of them covered the land.

Ferns and mosses do not have seeds, but reproduce from spores.

